10.2.4 Recording deployments and/or releases

When changes are deployed to production or any other environment, it's also a good idea to record which version is in which environment in Pact to signify that there has been a deployment or release made. The concepts of *deployment* and *release* are similar in Pact, but there are some slight differences. If a version is said to be deployed in Pact, this means that previous versions will be marked as not deployed. This also means that there will only be one version recorded as deployed. Recording deployments are useful for APIs and web applications where only one version of the code can be used. On the other hand, if a version is said to be released in Pact, previous versions will remain unaffected and will still be marked as released. Recording releases are useful for mobile apps where users can use different versions.

RECORDING A DEPLOYMENT

To record a deployment, we'll use the `pact-broker` command again but use the `record-deployment` option this time. Add the following scripts to your package.json file:

```
"scripts": {
   …
   "record:web:consumer:deployment":
"pact-broker record-deployment
--pacticipant WebConsumer --version $GITHUB_SHA
--environment production",
   "record:provider:deployment":
"pact-broker record-deployment --pacticipant MoviesAPI
--version $GITHUB_SHA --environment production"
   …
}
```

`record:web:consumer:deployment` records the WebConsumer's current version as the version that is deployed to production, while `record:provider:deployment` takes care of recording the provider version deployed to production. Next, let's add these two new commands as additional steps to our contract testing workflow by updating the contract-test-sample.yml file: